Bulletin

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GOVERNANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

- **NITDA Woos US Tech Firms To Invest In Nigeria's Digital Infrastructure** — Digital Times Nigeria, 28 October 2026 NIGERIA

  NITDA director general Kashifu Inuwa met a US business delegation that included Microsoft and Flutterwave. He asked them to invest in Nigeria's data centres and cloud infrastructure. He said the sovereign cloud initiative seeks national control of critical infrastructure and does not shut out foreign firms. Federal IT spending exceeded ₦4.5 trillion from June 2023 to June 2026, he said. *Also under Data Storage and US / hyperscaler activities.*

- **Namibia engages Meta, Microsoft and Google on digital content monetisation** — Tech Review Africa, 28 October 2026 NAMIBIA

  Namibia's ICT minister Emma Theofelus met Meta, Microsoft and Google, including YouTube, online to discuss what local creators need to earn money from content on their platforms. The US ambassador hosted the meeting. No agreement was announced. *Also under ICT Industry.*

- **Ethiopia Orders Telecom Regulator to Prioritise Service Quality and Affordability** — Tech Africa News, 28 October 2026 ETHIOPIA

  Ethiopia's Minister of Innovation and Technology, Frehiwot Tamru, told the Ethiopian Communications Authority on 27 October 2026 to judge its work by service quality, affordability, consumer protection and access. The ministry asked for measurable rural connectivity targets, firmer spectrum management and enforcement of quality-of-service rules. New postal legislation is to replace a proclamation of 1958 in the Ethiopian calendar. *Also under Connectivity.*

- **CBN warns banks on cybersecurity risks as cloud dependence grows** — BusinessDay Nigeria, 28 October 2026 NIGERIA

  CBN deputy governor Lamido Abubakar Yuguda spoke at a CBN-NITDA dialogue in Lagos on the National Sovereign Cloud Initiative. He told banks that keeping data in Nigeria does not by itself make it secure. Regulated institutions stay responsible for risks from cloud providers. They must hold critical payment data in Nigeria by 1 January 2027. *Also under Data Storage and Cybersecurity.*

- **Africa has its AI strategy, now come the foundations** — Institute for Security Studies (PSC Report), 28 October 2026 AFRICA

An Institute for Security Studies analysis reviews the AU Continental AI Strategy, adopted in July 2024. It says the strategy depends on connectivity, electricity and regulators that most member states lack. The strategy sets 15 action areas under five focus areas. Rwanda, Ghana and Zimbabwe are among the countries with national AI policies or strategies. *Also under AI and Public debate and participation in policymaking.*

- **22 Financial institutions yet to begin data localisation — NITDA survey** — Vanguard, 28 October 2026
  NIGERIA

  A NITDA survey of 44 financial institutions found 22 had not begun meeting Nigeria's payment data localisation rules. The deadline is 1 January 2027. The survey was presented at a NITDA-CBN dialogue in Lagos. On their own answers, 59% of firms were on track and 34% at risk. Most asked for a definition of payment transaction data. *Also under Data Storage.*

Legislation and regulation

- **Press Release: Zambia drops two places to finish in the 6th position on digital rights** — Paradigm Initiative, 28 October 2026 ZAMBIA

  Paradigm Initiative's Londa 2025 report ranks Zambia 6th of 29 African countries on digital rights and inclusion, two places lower than before. Its score fell from 40 to 37 out of 60. The report cites an energy crisis and high sector taxes as limits on access, and new cyber laws that risk rights violations. *Also under Public debate and participation in policymaking, Data protection and Digital divides.*

- **Kenya's 2027 Elections Will Test Its Commitment to Digital and Media Rights** — CIPESA, 28 October 2026
  KENYA

  CIPESA argues that Kenya's August 2027 elections will test its record on digital and media rights. It cites the Kenya Information and Communications Act and the Computer Misuse and Cybercrimes Act. The Media Council of Kenya counts more than 20 laws with provisions that threaten journalists. CIPESA also cites the risk of internet shutdowns and AI-made disinformation. *Also under Public debate and participation in policymaking, Cybersecurity and AI.*

- **26 countries sign Accra Convention to boost trade facilitation, digitalisation** — MyJoyOnline, 28 October 2026
  GHANA

  Twenty-six states signed the UN Convention on Negotiable Cargo Documents in Accra on 26 October 2026, with Ghana first. Known as the Accra Convention, it gives electronic cargo documents the legal effect of paper. Road, rail and air documents can serve as documents of title. Ghana's trade minister said it will ratify; the Convention needs ten ratifications. *Also under Data Exchange and Regional collaboration.*

Data protection

- **Press Release: Zambia drops two places to finish in the 6th position on digital rights** — Paradigm Initiative, 28 October 2026 ZAMBIA

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

Regional collaboration

- **رئيس هيئة الاتصالات يبحث مع وفد أفريقي تطوير البنية التحتية للإنترنت في ليبيا** — Libyan News Agency, 28 October 2026
  LIBYA

The head of Libya's General Authority for Communications and Informatics, Abdel Basset Al-Baour, met an AFRINIC delegation in Tripoli on 28 October 2026. They discussed IP address and autonomous system number allocation, network security, internet exchange points and national training. No agreement was reported. *Also under Connectivity*.

- **Gabon–Union africaine : un accord pour accélérer la coopération numérique** — GabonReview, 28 October 2026 GABON

  Gabon's digital economy minister Mark-Alexandre Doumba and AU Commissioner Lerato D. Mataboge signed a host country agreement on ICT cooperation in Libreville on 26 October 2026. The signing opened Gabon's Digital Week, which runs to 30 October. The agreement covers digital infrastructure and access to digital tools and services.

- **Calls to boost AI-driven cybersecurity cooperation against cybercrime** — Kenya News Agency, 28 October 2026 KENYA AFRICA

  Opening Cyberweek Africa 2026 in Nairobi, Kenya's ICT Cabinet Secretary William Kabogo called for closer African cooperation and intelligence sharing against AI-enabled cybercrime. His speech said the national KE-CIRT/CC recorded more than 11 billion threat events against Kenyan systems in the last financial year. It also said Parliament is considering accession to the Budapest Convention on Cybercrime. *Also under Cybersecurity*.

- **AUC Chairperson & H.E. Sergey Lavrov signed the AU Commission–Russian Federation Action Plan 2027–2029** — African Union Commission, 28 October 2026 AFRICA

  The AU Commission and Russia signed a non-binding Action Plan for 2027-2029 in Moscow on 28 October 2026, at the third Russia-Africa Summit. It spans 19 areas of cooperation. Its science and technology priorities include AI, digital transformation, cybersecurity and space technology, with joint work on AI-based early-warning systems. *Also under AI and Cybersecurity*.

- **26 countries sign Accra Convention to boost trade facilitation, digitalisation** — MyJoyOnline, 28 October 2026 GHANA

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

- **Gates Foundation says Nigeria must build AI around real-world problems** — TechCabal, 28 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Uche Amaonwu, head of the Gates Foundation's Nigeria office, spoke at the Moonshot conference in Lagos. He said Nigeria should measure AI by its effect on health, education, farming and public services. He named reliable connectivity, trusted data and interoperable systems as foundations. The foundation backs the Nigeria AI Building Hub at Lagos Business School. *Also under AI*.

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- **Kenya's 2027 Elections Will Test Its Commitment to Digital and Media Rights** — CIPESA, 28 October 2026 KENYA

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ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

- **Télécoms : le Liberia identifie les zones mal desservies pour étendre son réseau** — wearetech.africa, 28 October 2026 LIBERIA

  The Liberia Telecommunications Authority said on 26 October 2026 that it had chosen sites for 15 new towers under the Universal Access Fund. It had reviewed coverage gaps in 14 of the 15 counties. The fund already supports 15 towers. 4G covered 93% of the population in 2025. *Also under Digital divides.*

- **Rwanda Seeks $386 Million From South Korean Telecom Over 4G Dispute** — KT Press, 28 October 2026 RWANDA

  Rwanda filed a $386 million counterclaim against South Korea's KT Corporation at the Permanent Court of Arbitration on 20 October 2026. The dispute concerns their 4G joint venture, KT Rwanda Networks. KT had sought about $152 million in March 2026 to exit the venture. RURA ended the venture's 4G wholesale exclusivity in 2023; neither claim has been decided.

- **Loi de finances rectificative : médias publics en difficulté et risques de coupure d'Internet au cœur des échanges avec les députés** — Mediaguinee, 28 October 2026 GUINEA

  Guinea's digital economy ministry told a National Assembly commission on 27 October 2026 that the country relies on one submarine cable. The cable is near the end of its life and at risk of saturation. Damage to it would take the whole country offline, Secretary General Souleymane Thianguel Bah said. He asked MPs for more weight for the sector in the supplementary budget.

- **رئيس هيئة الاتصالات يبحث مع وفد أفريقي تطوير البنية التحتية للإنترنت في ليبيا** — Libyan News Agency, 28 October 2026 LIBYA

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- **Ethiopia Orders Telecom Regulator to Prioritise Service Quality and Affordability** — Tech Africa News, 28 October 2026 ETHIOPIA

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

Data Storage

- **Uptime Institute Awards in Cameroon** — Uptime Institute, 28 October 2026 CAMEROON

  Uptime Institute's register for Cameroon lists two Tier III design certifications. They cover Cameroon Telecommunications' Camtel NBN II data centre and MTN Cameroon's data centre, both in Yaoundé.

- **NITDA Woos US Tech Firms To Invest In Nigeria's Digital Infrastructure** — Digital Times Nigeria, 28 October 2026 NIGERIA

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- **CBN warns banks on cybersecurity risks as cloud dependence grows** — BusinessDay Nigeria, 28 October 2026 NIGERIA

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Cybersecurity

- **CYBER.EX 2026 : l'ANSSI veut préparer la Côte d'Ivoire aux crises numériques** — Linfodrome, 28 October 2026
  CÔTE D'IVOIRE

  Côte d'Ivoire's cybersecurity agency ANSSI opened CYBER.EX 2026, the country's first national cyber-crisis exercise, on 28 October 2026. It tests how government bodies, companies and the defence and security forces respond to a simulated cyberattack and work together.

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DPI

Data Exchange

- **Zimbabwe to fully operationalise Pangolin AI platform by Q1 2027** — Tech Review Africa, 28 October 2026
  ZIMBABWE

  Zimbabwe's ICT minister Tatenda Mavetera said the national AI and data platform, Pangolin AI, will be fully operational in the first quarter of 2027. The platform pools public health, agriculture and education data, while sensitive ministry data stays on local servers behind privacy-preserving interfaces. Her address was read at the POTRAZ-NUST Research and Innovation Symposium in Bulawayo. *Also under AI and Digital sovereignty.*

- **La Mauritanie explore l'expérience marocaine pour interconnecter ses administrations** — wearetech.africa, 28 October 2026 MAURITANIA MOROCCO

  Mauritania's state digital agency AN-ETAT visited Morocco's Digital Development Agency in Rabat to study its interoperability work, catalogue of shared solutions and open-data portal. The visit falls under a partnership between the two agencies as Mauritania links up its administrations' systems. No schedule for joint projects was announced. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

- **26 countries sign Accra Convention to boost trade facilitation, digitalisation** — MyJoyOnline, 28 October 2026 GHANA

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

Digital Identity and CRVS

- **South Africa plans biometric asylum registration, tighter digital border controls** — Biometric Update, 28 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  South Africa's Department of Home Affairs plans an online booking system for asylum seekers by 10 November 2026. It will collect biometric and identity data. The step follows a July Constitutional Court ruling that struck down Refugees Act barriers to asylum procedures. The government is also building electronic border systems and weighing stricter SIM registration for foreign nationals. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

- **Internal Affairs Ministry Explores Biometric Technology Partnership With Aratek** — Nile Post, 28 October 2026 UGANDA

  Uganda's Ministry of Internal Affairs held exploratory talks with Aratek Biometrics on a possible partnership in biometric technology and digital systems. State Minister Juma Witonze Kisekka chaired the meeting. No scope, technology or implementation plan was agreed.

Digital Payments and Fintech

- **Tap, pay, go: Mastercard and Interswitch bring Google Pay to Nigeria** — TechCabal, 28 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Mastercard and Interswitch launched Google Pay contactless payments for eligible Mastercard holders in Nigeria, using Mastercard tokenisation and Interswitch links to issuing banks. Supported cards include those of FirstBank, GTBank, UBA and Zenith. On 26 October 2026 Interswitch announced tap-to-pay tokenisation with five banks.

- **Russia-Africa Economic and Humanitarian Forum** — President of Russia (Kremlin), 28 October 2026 AFRICA

  President Vladimir Putin addressed the third Russia-Africa Economic and Humanitarian Forum in Moscow. He offered African states Russian e-government systems and digital know-how. He said Russia has two large language models of its own. He proposed the Bank of Russia's Financial Messaging System alongside PAPSS for settlements. Over 200 African civil servants have joined a Russian digitalisation training programme. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov, AI and Training and skills.*

Registries

- **UCC Seeks Digital Upgrade of Posta Uganda, Nationwide Addressing System** — Nile Post, 28 October 2026 UGANDA

  The Uganda Communications Commission is seeking technical help from the Universal Postal Union for a National Addressing System and a digital upgrade of Posta Uganda. Executive director Nyombi Thembo said so after attending Uganda's first UPU Administrative Council meeting in Berne. The addressing system is to be delivered under the fourth National Development Plan.

Sectoral management information systems

- **Mais de 31 mil funcionários públicos suspeitos de serem 'fantasma' terão de provar efectividade, diz MAPTSS** — Novo Jornal, 28 October 2026 ANGOLA

Angola's Ministry of Public Administration, Labour and Social Security launched SINGERH, a single human-resources database for the civil service, on 28 October 2026. Minister Teresa Rodrigues Dias said more than 31,000 staff listed as active could not be validated and are suspected of being 'ghost' workers. Over 300,000 public servants were registered between January and September 2026. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

Other GovTech and e-Gov

- **Unblocking Domestic Resource Mobilization through AI Tools: Introducing the Optimizing African Revenue Authorities for Responsible AI Adoption Project** — Development Gateway, 28 October 2026 AFRICA

  The African Tax Administration Forum and Development Gateway launched a 12-month project, backed by the Hewlett Foundation, on responsible use of AI by African revenue authorities. It will survey AI readiness across ATAF's 45 member states to set a continental benchmark. Three selected authorities will get help to draft AI strategies and roadmaps. *Also under AI.*

- **Guinée : la numérisation s'étend à la gestion des activités de pêche** — wearetech.africa, 28 October 2026 GUINEA

  Guinea launched KONKÖE, a platform for fisheries and maritime administration also called SIGPEM, in Conakry on 26 October 2026, with public use from 1 November. Its first phase covers vessel owners, the national vessel register, fishing licences and access to the exclusive economic zone. A fishing professionals' body asked for help at landing sites and explanations in national languages.

- **South Africa plans biometric asylum registration, tighter digital border controls** — Biometric Update, 28 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Summarised under Digital Identity and CRVS.

- **Russia-Africa Economic and Humanitarian Forum** — President of Russia (Kremlin), 28 October 2026 AFRICA

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  Summarised under Data Exchange.

Technology

AI

- **Talent Pipelines Versus Compute Limits: Inside Rwanda's AI Skills Agreement** — Tech Africa News, 28 October 2026 RWANDA

  Rwanda's ICT ministry signed a memorandum with the AI Skills and Compute Africa Foundation in Kigali in October 2026. It covers AI skills, research and local solutions, and commits no new public money or computing capacity. By September 2026 the foundation had made 42 grants in 14 countries. It uses 50 NVIDIA H200 GPUs given by Cassava Technologies. *Also under Training and skills and Digital sovereignty.*

- **Scaling small- and medium-sized enterprise artificial intelligence through governance: A Technology-Organisation-Environment readiness synthesis for information management** — South African Journal of Information Management (SAJIM), 28 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  A scoping review in the South African Journal of Information Management covers 72 studies published from 2021 to 2025 on how small and medium firms adopt AI. It finds that responsible AI governance helps such firms turn pilots into repeatable value while keeping customers' trust. The authors apply the findings to Cape Town and the Western Cape. *Also under ICT Industry*.

- **Zimbabwe to fully operationalise Pangolin AI platform by Q1 2027** — Tech Review Africa, 28 October 2026 ZIMBABWE

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- **Gates Foundation says Nigeria must build AI around real-world problems** — TechCabal, 28 October 2026 NIGERIA

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Capacity

Training and skills

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Inclusion

Digital divides

- **Télécoms : le Liberia identifie les zones mal desservies pour étendre son réseau** — wearetech.africa, 28 October 2026 LIBERIA

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  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

Data

Use of satellite data

- **Zim to launch a third satellite** — NewsDay, 28 October 2026 ZIMBABWE

  Zimbabwe is preparing to launch a third satellite, said Fanuel Tagwira, permanent secretary of the higher education, innovation, science and technology ministry. He spoke at the AARSE International Conference in Harare, which opened on 26 October 2026. No launch date was given.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

- **NITDA Woos US Tech Firms To Invest In Nigeria's Digital Infrastructure** — Digital Times Nigeria, 28 October 2026 NIGERIA

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Digital sovereignty

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EDITION	**2026-10-29**
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This bulletin is produced automatically at the end of each data collection sweep but only includes items published on the day cited in the edition, and the previous day. Items published in the last month can be found on the country pages. The links to all items stored in the corpus can be found in the catalogue.

Bulletins are kept for a week — the last week's editions are listed above, each at its own dated address — and are then deleted. Older material is in the country and region news.